



Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) - OPS-004

Telephone & Enquiry Handling

Purpose

To ensure all telephone calls and enquiries are handled professionally, consistently and efficiently, providing an excellent first impression of the clinic whilst ensuring clients receive accurate information and timely responses.

Responsibility

This procedure should be followed by all Receptionists, Administrators and any member of staff responsible for answering telephone calls or responding to client enquiries.

General Standards

When communicating with clients, always:

- Answer calls in a friendly, professional and welcoming manner.
- Speak clearly and confidently.
- Listen carefully and avoid interrupting the caller.
- Remain calm, polite and empathetic at all times.
- Maintain confidentiality and comply with GDPR requirements.
- Never provide medical advice unless you are a qualified clinician authorised to do so.
- If unsure of an answer, advise the caller you will find out and return their call rather than guessing.

Answering the Telephone

Use the following greeting:

"Good morning/afternoon, Radiant Medical Aesthetics & Wellbeing, you're speaking with [Name]. How may I help you today?"

If you are unable to answer immediately, return missed calls as soon as reasonably possible.

Handling Enquiries

Establish the reason for the enquiry before responding.

Common enquiries may include:

- Booking appointments
- Treatment information
- Prices
- Practitioner availability
- Clinic opening hours
- Directions and parking

- Gift vouchers
- Membership enquiries
- General clinic information

Provide accurate information using the clinic's approved pricing lists, treatment information and policies.

If a medical or treatment suitability question is asked, explain that a consultation with one of the clinic's qualified practitioners will be required before advice can be given.

Booking Appointments

When making a booking:

- Confirm the client's full name.
- Confirm their preferred contact number and email address.
- Book the appointment using the clinic booking system (ANS).
- Confirm the appointment date, time and practitioner.
- Explain any consultation requirements or pre-treatment instructions where applicable.
- Advise the client that confirmation and any required forms will be sent electronically.

Taking Messages

If the appropriate member of staff is unavailable:

- Record the caller's full name.
- Obtain a contact telephone number.
- Record the reason for their call.
- Note the date and time of the message.
- Pass the message to the appropriate team member as soon as possible.

Where possible, advise the caller when they can expect a response.

Managing Difficult Calls

If a caller is upset or unhappy:

- Remain calm and professional.
- Listen without interrupting.
- Acknowledge their concerns.
- Avoid becoming defensive.
- Explain that their concerns will be passed to the appropriate member of the team.
- Escalate complaints in accordance with the clinic's Complaints Procedure.

Responding to Other Enquiries

Enquiries received via email, WhatsApp, social media or website forms should:

- Be acknowledged promptly.
- Receive a professional and friendly response.
- Be responded to as soon as reasonably possible during clinic opening hours.
- Be recorded or actioned where appropriate.
- Be referred to the relevant practitioner if clinical advice is required.

Daily Responsibilities

Reception staff should regularly:

- Check for missed calls and voicemails.

- Respond to unanswered enquiries promptly.
- Monitor emails, WhatsApp messages and social media inboxes throughout the day.
- Ensure all enquiries are followed up and completed where required.
- Escalate any urgent issues to the appropriate practitioner or manager.